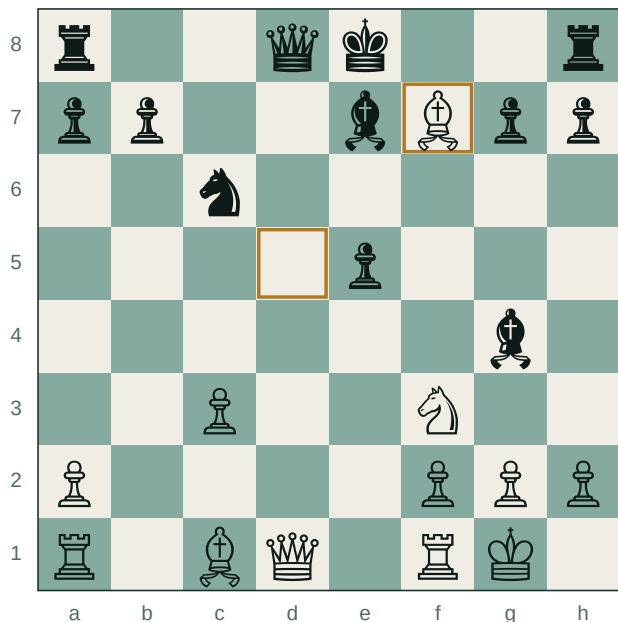


Loose-piece tactics: Black, move 13

Loose-piece tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 13.Bxf7+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

13...Kxf7 14. Ng5+ Bxg5

13...Kxf7 The king captures the bishop on f7. Recorded reply: **14.Ng5+**.

14...Bxg5 The bishop captures the knight on g5.

At the end, nominal material is White 27 / Black 33 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +6. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +6:** the balance goes from +0 to +6. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A piece may appear hanging because its defender is indirect: taking it might allow mate, a fork, or a stronger capture.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An undefended or tactically undefendable piece can turn an ordinary position into a combination. The first task is to distinguish a truly free capture from a poisoned one.

HOW TO LOOK

List the loose enemy pieces and check whether a forcing move can expose or attack more than one of them.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: bishop on f7 and rook on a1. Check for tactical protection.